

An abstract graphic featuring a large, faceted, translucent blue crystal-like shape in the center. Behind it is a glowing purple ring. The background is a solid deep purple. A white speech bubble icon is positioned above the main text.

master your communication

mercurious report

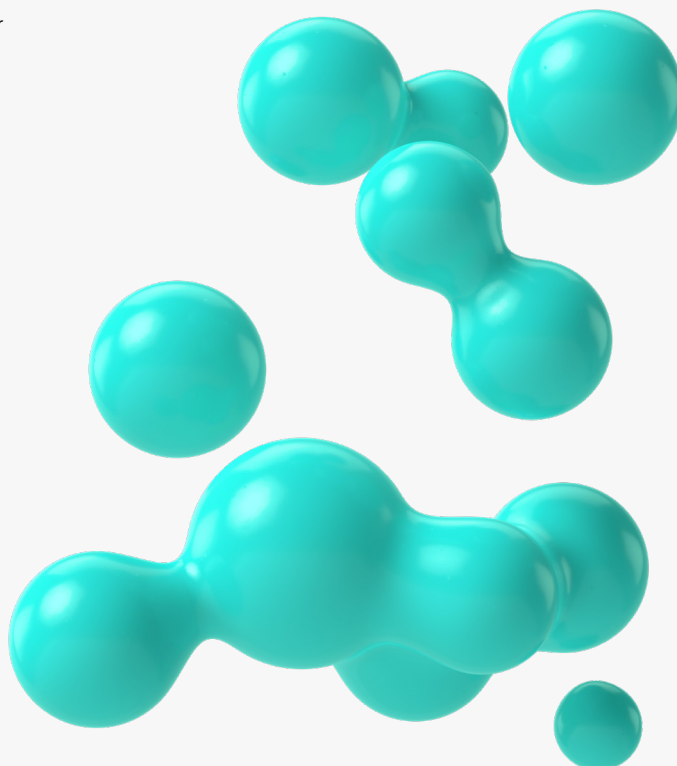
We are proud and grateful.

We founded mercurio.us with the desire to answer a nagging question; how can we understand each other better?

Our founding team all have solid backgrounds in communication. Partly in roles as coaches, team leaders, communication advisors and leadership experts. But also as deeply curious and engaged human beings.

There are some moments in life which may carry significance for many years to come. We hope this is one of them. To begin to understand and master the communicated language is to gain access to a powerful resource which can change many aspects of your career, relationships and everyday life.

We hope this report will make this day an important one for you.



Introduction

how do you do?

Communication is the foundation of all leadership. We are convinced that when we understand how we communicate, it improves our ability to lead ourselves and others. The purpose of this report is to bring you perspectives which you can use for deepening your understanding of your own communication and the communication of others. The report is based on linguistic communication patterns that we all tend to have in various situations. The different segments of the report are based on the following communication patterns:

Motivation

How we motivate ourselves and others through our communication

Decisions

How we seek a basis for our decision making through our communication

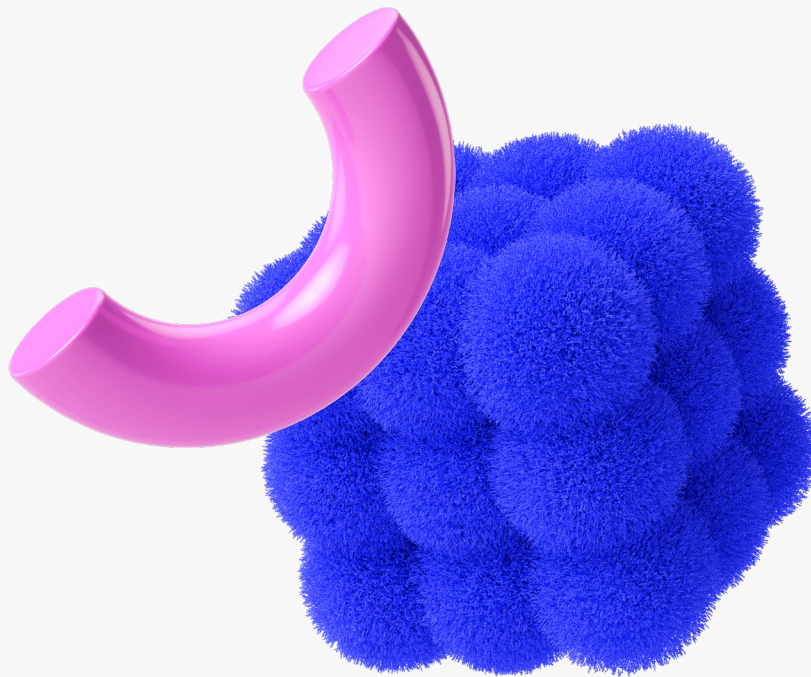
Understanding

How we create understanding through our communication

Senses

What "channel" - senses we tend to rely on in our communication





This is how we create your report

You answer a survey with anumber of open questions—to make sure your own words are being expressed. Your responses are analysed by our experts, who manually categorize your communication according to the four communication patterns in focus.

From the analysis, we create a report— which you are now reading. You receive this written report in conjunction with a session with your facilitator or coach, who guides you through it personally. By receiving these perspectives on how we communicate, we have the opportunity to add communication patterns we currently don't use—with the intention to become more clear in our communication and connect better with others. This analysis is often used to develop the communication of both individuals and teams. By together understanding our communication differences and similarities, we are given the

opportunity to create exactly the type of communication we need to become more efficient, avoid unnecessary conflict and reach our objectives.

These communication patterns are based on research and experience within both neurolinguistics and communications theory. Please note that this report offers a perspective on how you sometimes communicate and sometimes don't. It doesn't say anything about who you are or your behaviours. However, it may say something about how you are perceived and interpreted by others.

If you wish to learn more about the underlying research and theories, please visit mercurio.us



Introduction

we are not our patterns

A common challenge with tests is that we mix things up and confuse ourselves.

We mix up communication, behaviour and identity. We identify with the result. In the long run, this often adds to the problem the test intended to help us overcome, and rather reinforces our challenges.

We are not colors and we are not test results. We are human beings with a multitude of complex and shifting aspects, which no test can ever identify. Still, there are many psychological tests that are valuable for diagnosing illness or identifying deeper questions in recruiting etc.

The colors

A commonly used test is the one categorizing people into colors. It claims we have four basic behaviours identified as red, yellow, blue or green. Four behaviours influenced, for instance, by stress and where we move towards a specific type of adapted behaviour.

The problem is that we tend to identify with the behaviours we recognize in ourselves or others. That can reinforce a potentially invalid self image, or reinforce the very behaviours the test is highlighting. I am red, so why should I change? I am yellow, so I am a creative person.

Our approach to behavioural tests is that they are just that—tests offering perspectives on behaviour. They don't tell you anything about who you are or how you communicate. Your communication is dependent on many factors, including situation, context, person, norms, interpretations and how communication is experienced in the moment.

With a mercurio.us test, you get perspectives on how you tend to communicate in certain contexts and how you tend to interpret the communication from others. It doesn't say anything about who you are or what you do.



Introduction

three perspectives

The experience of meeting another person involves many forms of information exchange. We see each other, we listen and we experience. We are sensing organisms who can experience different things in different ways in different situations—depending on who we perceive ourselves to be, what we do and how we communicate. With well-functioning communication, we collaborate better. When we understand each other, we create and evolve together. Well-functioning communication is a prerequisite for accessing the safety and stability we need to feel well, be present and evolve.

Similarly, when we don't communicate well, collaboration suffers, conflicts arise more often, costly misunderstandings increase, and we get stuck in unnecessary discussions which stops us from evolving.

Traditionally communication is described as part of a behaviour. That we do our communication. Today, we know that we learn more about our communication when we treat it as its own phenomenon—a third perspective. For instance, any inner dialogue is a communication process—not a behaviour.

Someone expressing something and someone doing something are two different things.

When we receive communication from someone, we often perceive it to be part of their identity and personality. I might think you are certain way, because you do or say things a certain way. We have values as part of our experienced identity, connected to different ways of communicating. Someone speaking to you with their arms crossed, might be perceived to be distanced or relaxed—depending on your interpretation. This is one of the reasons why communication can be challenging.

Because we mix up these three perspectives.



Identity

One way to define identity is who we perceive ourselves to be in the moment. As we grow older and learn more, we gain perspectives and develop our values and experiences, shaping our identity.

Behaviour

Behaviour is everything we do in our daily lives. To walk is a behaviour. To sit, stand, drive, swim and jump are other examples.

Communication

Our communication is the interpretations we make of what is happening within us and around us. Through communication we create relationships to each other, understand our world, and create trusting contexts. Through communication, we get to know each other and get things done together. Through communication we collaborate.

Communication has always been a survival strategy. Is the person we meet dangerous or kind? Friend or foe? Does the person wish us harm or wellbeing? When the communication runs well, we relax—or not.

Non-functioning communication in an organization creates unnecessary stress and misunderstandings. Communication impacts our behaviour and who we perceive ourselves to be. For instance, today we know that clear, specific and supportive feedback increases a person's self-esteem at the workplace. Thus, well-functioning communication strengthens the individual's self-perception. When faced with communication which is unfamiliar to us, or that we associate with danger, signals in our brains prepare us to protect ourselves. When we grow up, we are influenced by the communication patterns around us.

The patterns we interpret as good or bad will influence how we express ourselves. We identify with our communication. Our communication is a tool for creating recognition and identification.

Just like we identify with our communication, we are shaped by the behaviours we experience around us as we grow up. Certain behaviours we interpret as right—others as wrong. We identify with our behaviours, which also means we interpret others based on our own patterns. So another person's behaviour is something we interpret. Thus, the results of what we do becomes someone else's communication and identity. If someone acts in accordance with your perception of right and wrong, you will interpret that person's behaviour as clear. If someone acts in a way which is not in accordance with your perception of right and wrong, you will likely interpret that person's behaviour as unclear. Our identity is a representative interpretation of who we perceive to be here and now. It is the collected perception of our values, experiences and feelings of who we are and who we wish to be. Thus, how we believe that we are, act and communicate.

Based on who we perceive ourselves to be, we'll have behaviours and communication reinforcing our identity. Thus, one could say that our identity is created in the present moment and it directs our behaviour and communication in any given situation.

Similarly, our identity is impacted by behaviours and communication from our surroundings. We live with the people we perceive to understand. Our friends are people acting and communicating based on values we feel are important. As living mammals on this planet, communication is crucial for our survival. This is one of the reasons why this report may be important for your development. You are who you are. This report has nothing to say about that. It doesn't evaluate right or wrong behaviours. This report is merely offering perspectives on your communication and what patterns you tend to have in a given situation. It says nothing about your identity or your behaviours. But it may say something about how you are perceived and interpreted by others.

It is up to you to take your new knowledge and insights to the next level. To reflect on how your communication can be taken to the next level. To become a little more curious about your communication.



Segment #1

communication

What are communication patterns?

In the field of communication we tend to talk about communication patterns—different ways to put together words and sentences so that the receiver can make their own interpretation of what we're saying. Communication patterns is something we all use more or less consciously. We all have a way to say what we wish to say.

This report focuses on four categories of communication patterns. These patterns give us many clues and together they create a key for us to become more successful in reaching others. Communication patterns are not about who you are as person, but rather how you communicate in different situations based on how you perceive and interpret them. We are constantly bombarded with impressions (approx. 2 million/second) through all of our sensations. Our brains automatically process all those impressions. Those processes we call communication patterns.

History

Noam Chomsky, linguistics professor, wrote a whitepaper about generative grammar in 1957 (Transformational Grammar). In Chomsky's work, the sensation processing in the brain was defined. These processes are filters we use to deal with all the information streaming through us from outside us and inside us—for instance a thought arising in our consciousness or a signal that something is touching our arm. We constantly use these filters to create our own experienced version of reality. Thus, we have filters for interpreting our surroundings and ourselves. Leslie Cameron-Bandler developed Chomsky's work further and claimed that we all have different variations of all of these processes. Cameron-Bandler identified 60 different patterns. Those patterns decide what we focus on, prioritize and choose to perceive in our experienced reality.

Rodger Bailey joined in the 1980's and found that among those 60 patterns, some are more commonly present than others. Cameron-Bandler and Bailey also found that people's communication patterns match their behaviours. Thus, when we use a

certain way to communicate, we tend to act in accordance with our communication. This is one of the reasons why we often mix up what other people do and say—especially when we don't recognize the patterns playing out, or they represent something we associate with "wrong" or "dangerous". As an example, unclear communication generates stress. Today there are approx. 80 identified communication patterns helping us categorize our communication in different ways. These patterns are applicable in many different situations when we express what is, and isn't, important for us in our lives.

Filters

Communication patterns are different ways of filtering experiences. We can't perceive and react upon all the information our senses pick up. We sort out about 110 information units (bits) from 2 million each second (Mihaly Csikszentmihaly from the book "Flow"). To accomplish this, we have filters leaving out, generalizing, and distorting information. We are mostly unaware of how our communication patterns filter our experienced reality in this way. Our communication patterns can be identified both through our communication and our behaviour. Communication patterns filter our experiences and pass on our experiences through the use of language.

Communication pattern awareness brings us the ability to:

- Connect better with others
- Be more precise in our communication
- Increase motivation in ourselves and others
- Understand how other people perceive the world

Communication patterns are general sorting filters that have been discovered when studying how people process information. The patterns a person plays out change depending on the situation and context. Thus, before analysing another person's patterns, it is crucial to identify the specific context (e.g. work, vacation, parenting etc). In business, these theories are commonly used for recruitment, team building, individual development etc.



Five important perspectives:

- All communication patterns are equally valuable in the right situation. No pattern is better or worse. It depends on the context.
- The patterns describe the communication, not the person.
- The patterns uncover tendencies, not universal truths.
- Some people express a pattern to the extreme, but most have a mix of the two. Some balance in-between the extremes.
- Pay attention to the context! Communication patterns might differ with context. A person may, for instance, have the pattern "procedure" at work and "alternative" at home.

This report focuses on four situations and categories of the most important processes for creating and achieving clearer communication:

1. Understanding - What do we focus on when we need to understand? How do we express ourselves to be clear? How do we understand and make ourselves understood?

2. Motivation - How do we motivate ourselves and others? How do we express motivation?

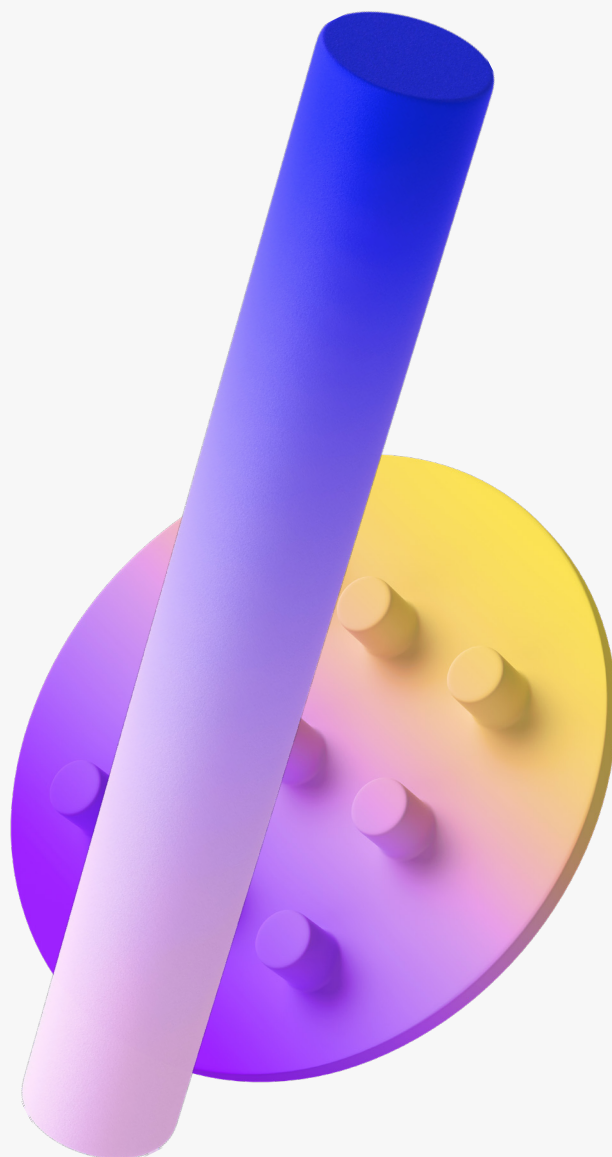
3. Decision making - How do we motivate ourselves to make decisions? What do we base our decision making on?

4. Connecting - How do we express what is important for us? How do we communicate using different senses? How do we highlight our sensory preferences in our words?

HOW is more important than WHAT

Communication patterns are filters we use in spoken language. To identify different filters, we ask questions and listen to the response without adding any particular value to it. We are focused on HOW the person responds to allow us to identify patterns, rather than WHAT the person says or what it means to us.

All people have communication patterns as filters for processing impressions. There are no benefits of having a particular filter. The variations of filters we find it most difficult to identify are likely the ones we don't have much access to ourselves.



Segment #2

your report

Welcome to your mercurio.us report. You will be given a number of insights, hopefully assisting you in developing your own communication and leadership.

You can view this report as an advanced form of feedback on how your communication works and what aspects of your communication you can develop. It is up to you what you do with these perspectives and insights. Some settle for the feedback. Others take it to the next level and learn which tools can help them enforce important relationships. Some understand how central their communication is to their success, and choose to treat these insights as a milestone in their careers. You make of it what you will.

Important to keep in mind

This report is not intended for recruitment purposes, evaluating people's behaviour or making any type of decisions about any person. The report is designed to be explored by individuals and teams seeking to develop their communication.

Also, this report is not presenting any absolute truth, but rather feedback and perspectives. We invite you to stay curious and explore with an open mind because it may hold surprises for you. For some, this report will confirm what they already know. For others, it will evoke new thoughts about oneself and others, and uncover hidden aspects of your communication. We invite you to stay curious and notice your own reaction.

It is worth repeating that this report is not a profile of your identity, who you are, or your behaviour. What it is, however, is a clear form of feedback on what patterns you have in your communication.

All communication is impacted by who we are, what we do and who we interact with in any given situation. Thus, you may have

different patterns in different situations. However, based on the thousands of reports we have done, it is clear that we tend to have the same patterns in similar situations.

This report is also an invitation for you to explore further and deepen your knowledge about how you communicate and what you can develop in your leadership. The report may also bring you a clearer image of your team (if the team report is part of this specific order). The art of leading oneself emerges from understanding what each of us needs in order to lead ourselves. To learn about our own communication and our own patterns gives us the opportunity to understand how we create understanding, motivate ourselves and make decisions. This report gives you feedback on those very things. In teams, the level of trust between individuals is instrumental. How quickly we can build trust and increase connection within a team is most often the key to success. With this report, you may be able to uncover hidden potential to avoid misunderstandings and increase efficiency.

The report covers four communications patterns of relevance for your leadership:

Your motivation - how do you motivate yourself and others?

Your decisions - how do you make decisions and how do others make decisions?

Your understanding - how to you understand information and make yourself understood?

Your primary communication channels - Which sense do you mostly use to listen and communicate to others?

Each segment of this report is built around a scale. Your communication will be higher or lower on the various pattern scales, depending on how you communicate and the context.



Content index

segment #1 - communication	8
segment #2 - your report.....	12
index	11
your profile - summary	13
segment #3 - understanding.....	15
segment #4 - motivation	19
segment #5 - decisions.....	23
segment #6 - channels for communication.....	27

